

Move Fabric Flo to your Windows 11 PC

A plain-English, step-by-step guide. No prior experience assumed. Generated for the operator · June 2026

Your project now lives safely on GitHub at

<https://github.com/KeatingMichael/fabric-flo> . That changes everything: moving to a new computer is now a **download**, not a risky file copy. Nothing on your Mac gets damaged — you are making a *fresh copy* on Windows.

What works where

- **Windows 11** → run the app, develop, and build/submit the **Android** app. 
- **Apple (iOS)** → Apple requires a Mac somewhere. You do **not** need to own one — use **Codemagic** (cloud Mac that builds from GitHub). See [docs/FINISH_AND_SUBMIT_CHECKLIST.md](#) .

The big picture (3 steps)

1. Install three free tools on Windows (Git, Node 20, optionally Android Studio).
2. **Clone** (download) the project from GitHub with one command.
3. Run `npm install` then `npm run dev` and confirm the app opens.

That's it. The rest of this doc is just the detail for each step.

Method A — GitHub (recommended, clean and safe)

1. Install the tools on Windows 11

Install these by downloading from the official sites (accept the default options):

Tool	Link	Why
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Git for Windows	https://git-scm.com/download/win	Downloads the project and saves your changes
Node.js 20 LTS	https://nodejs.org/en/download	Runs the app (<code>.nvmrc</code> pins version 20)
GitHub Desktop <i>(optional, easiest)</i>	https://desktop.github.com	Clone/push with buttons instead of typing
Android Studio <i>(only for Android builds)</i>	https://developer.android.com/studio	Builds the Android app + emulator
VS Code or Cursor <i>(to edit)</i>	https://cursor.com	Same editor experience as your Mac

Node tip: after installing, open a new terminal and run `node -v` — it should print `v20.x` .

2A. Clone with GitHub Desktop (no typing — easiest)

1. Open **GitHub Desktop** → **File** ▶ **Clone repository**.
2. Sign in to GitHub (the same `KeatingMichael` account).
3. Pick `KeatingMichael/fabric-flo` from the list.
4. Choose a local folder (e.g. `C:\Users\You\Documents`) → **Clone**.

You now have the whole project on Windows. Skip to **step 3**.

2B. Clone with the command line (alternative)

Open **Git Bash** (installed with Git) or **PowerShell** and run:

```
cd ~/Documents
git clone https://github.com/KeatingMichael/fabric-flo.git
cd fabric-flo
```

If it asks you to sign in, a browser window will pop up — click **Authorize**. (This is the same sign-in you set up on the Mac; on Windows it's handled automatically by the Git Credential Manager, so you should not have to deal with tokens again.)

3. Install dependencies and run it

From inside the `fabric-flo` folder:

```
npm install
npm run dev
```

Open the printed URL (e.g. `http://localhost:5173`) in your browser. If the Fabric Flo marketing page loads at `/` and the app at `/app`, **the transfer worked.** 🎉

4. Recreate your secrets file (`.env`)

`.env` is **intentionally not** on GitHub (it holds secrets). Recreate it on Windows:

1. In the project, copy `.env.example` to a new file named `.env`.
2. Fill in the same values you use on the Mac:
 - `VITE_SUPABASE_URL`
 - `VITE_SUPABASE_ANON_KEY`
 - `VITE_FABRIC_FLO_BACKEND=normalized`
 - `VITE_PUBLIC_APP_URL`, `VITE_SUPPORT_EMAIL`,
`VITE_PRIVACY_EMAIL`

*Find these in your Supabase dashboard (**Project Settings** ▶ **API**) and your Netlify settings. Never commit `.env` — `.gitignore` already blocks it.*

5. Save future changes back to GitHub

After editing on Windows, send your work back so every machine stays in sync:

```
git add -A
git commit -m "Describe what you changed"
git push
```

(Or in GitHub Desktop: write a summary → **Commit to main** → **Push origin**.)

Method B — Manual copy (USB / external drive) — fallback only

Use this **only** if you can't use GitHub. It's slower and easier to get wrong.

1. On the Mac, **quit** anything using the project.
2. Copy the **entire FABRIC FLO APP** folder to a USB drive — **but delete these first** (they're huge and rebuild automatically): `node_modules`, `dist`, `ios/App/Pods`.
3. On Windows, copy the folder off the USB to e.g. `C:\Users\You\Documents\fabric-flo`.
4. Open a terminal there and run `npm install`, then `npm run dev`.
5. Recreate `.env` (step 4 above).
6. **Reconnect it to GitHub** so you still get backups:

```
git remote -v          # if this prints origin, you're
                        already connected
git push
```

If `origin` is missing:

```
git remote add origin
https://github.com/KeatingMichael/fabric-flo.git
git push -u origin main
```

*You do **not** need USB for your friend's Mac either — they can `git clone` the same GitHub repo.*

After it's running on Windows — what's different?

Task	Windows 11	Notes
Run the web app / develop	✓ <code>npm run dev</code>	Identical to Mac
Build the web/PWA	✓ <code>npm run build</code>	Identical

Deploy to Netlify	✓ <code>npm run netlify:deploy</code>	Identical
Build the Android app	✓ Android Studio	<code>npm run cap:sync</code> then open <code>android/</code>
Build the iOS app	✗ not on Windows	Use Codemagic (cloud Mac) or a friend's Mac
Generate PDFs / icons	✓	Same npm scripts

The `npm run build:native` script is **Mac-only** (it shells out to a bash script and Xcode). On Windows, build Android directly:

```
npm run build
npx cap sync android
npm run cap:android      # opens Android Studio
```

Then in Android Studio: **Build ▶ Generate Signed App Bundle** to get the `.aab` for Google Play.

Sanity checklist (tick these on Windows before you trust it)

- ☐ `node -v` prints `v20.x`
- ☐ `git clone` (or copy) completed without errors
- ☐ `npm install` finished
- ☐ `npm run dev` opens the app at `/` and `/app`
- ☐ `.env` recreated with your Supabase + URL values
- ☐ `git push` succeeds (a tiny test edit shows up on GitHub)

When all six are checked, your Mac is free to hand off. Continue with **`docs/FINISH_AND_SUBMIT_CHECKLIST.md`** to get into both app stores.

Fabric Flo — Film fabric & bag tracker for productions. Repo:

<https://github.com/KeatingMichael/fabric-flo>